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MAINTENANCE WORKERS, above, cover up a mural honoring Cesar Chavez at Santa Ana College as Daniella Marcial, right, studies. The labor leader's name is on many schools, streets and other public places.

UFW dealing with Chavez fallout

BY IAN JAMES
AND BRITTNY MEJIA

The country's oldest and most influential farmworkers union, already embroiled in a legal dispute with the Trump administration, is now grappling with how to respond to the uproar over sex abuse allegations against famed labor leader Cesar Chavez.

Teresa Romero, president of the United Farm Workers, said the union wants to be supportive of the women who said they were sexually abused by Chavez decades ago.

"I want to make sure that we respect the courage of these women who came forward to share these difficult stories," Romero said in an interview. "I want to make sure that we respect them and give them the space for them to talk about it."

An investigation by the New York Times reported that Chavez, a co-founder of the union, had sexually abused two girls, and fellow union leader Dolores Huerta said he had raped her in the 1960s.

The allegations stunned farmworkers across the nation, many who revered him as a hero.

At a rally in support of the UFW in Fresno on Wednesday, Carolina Sánchez, a farmworker from Delano, said she did not want to believe the allegations.

"We're in shock," Sánchez said.

Romero, who started working with the union several years after Chavez died in 1993, said she first learned details of the accusations in the New York Times article. She said she has never met the women who said they were abused as girls in the 1970s.

"Any abuse of a woman or a child, anything like that, is unforgivable," Romero said. "We don't justify it. We don't accept it. That's not who we are."

The UFW said in a written statement that the "troubling allegations" against Chavez "are incompatible with our organization's values." The union said it had not "received any

[See UFW, A6]

A push to rename holiday as 'Farmworkers Day'

BY KAREN GARCIA, MELISSA GOMEZ,
HOWARD BLUME, BRITTNY MEJIA AND JAWEED KALEEM

California is moving quickly to rename Cesar Chavez Day in the wake of sex abuse allegations against the famed labor leader.

The push to redesignate the March 31 holiday as "Farmworkers Day" was announced Thursday by Democratic leaders in the state Legislature.

"California's farmworker rights movement never has been about one individual. To the survivors who have found the courage to come forward, uplifting the movement's values of dignity and justice, and demanding accountability, our hearts are with you always," Assembly Speaker Robert Rivas (D-Hollister) and Senate President Pro Tem Monique Limón (D-Goleta) said in a joint statement.

Some Republicans, too, have expressed a desire to continue honoring the wider farmworker labor movement, even while minimizing Chavez as an individual figure. State Sen. Suzette Martinez Valladares (R-Ac-ton) and Assemblywoman Alexandra M. Macedo (R-Tulare) said Wednesday they were already working on legislation to rename the holiday to Farmworkers Day.

Gov. Gavin Newsom indicated support for the effort on social media and during remarks at an unrelated event.

"What Cesar represented was a movement — the farmworkers' movement, the labor movement — and it's right to celebrate that movement," he said. "And so I'm certainly supportive of the direction that many are promoting, including members of the Legislature, and we look forward to moving that along in an expeditious way."

Calls to purge Chavez from the litany of schools, streets and parks named in his honor followed publication Wednesday of a New York Times investigation detailing disturbing allegations that Chavez sexually assaulted two underage girls in the 1970s, as well as fellow iconic farmworker leader Dolores Huerta in the 1960s.

Huerta, as well as one of the girls, said Chavez raped her.

The claims immediately became a political issue across California and other states, where Chavez has been memorialized in many ways since his death in 1993.

[See Chavez, A6]

Screen-time battle in classrooms

Parents are growing increasingly alarmed about schools' reliance on devices for young students



CHRISTINA HOUSE Los Angeles Times

KATE BRODY said her son, 7, would ignore his body's signals while using a tablet computer at school.

BY KATE SEQUEIRA

Frustration is simmering among parents who say their young children are spending too much classroom time online, disrupting their learning and development at a crucial time and clashing with stricter screen restrictions at home.

Grassroots coalitions across California and nationwide are emerging in school districts, including in Los Angeles, San Diego and San Marcos, as parents grow increasingly alarmed that digital activities are replacing hands-on learning and peer interaction with little oversight. Groups want more transparency on technology use, strict limits on screen time and more risk

[See Devices, A8]

Industrial chemicals taint all oceans

BY SUSANNE RUST

New research shows the chemicals we use to kill pests, heal our bodies and package our foods are spread throughout the ocean, intermingling with the microorganisms that feed marine life. They've reached even the most distant and remote places on the planet.

In a new study, Daniel Petras, a biochemist at UC Riv-

erside — together with 29 researchers from around the world — looked at 2,315 seawater samples collected from estuaries, coastal regions, coral reefs and the open ocean. The samples came from the North Pacific, the Baltic Sea and the coast of South Africa, among other places. For each sample, the researchers used a relatively new technique that allowed them to see every chemical present — not just ones they were looking

for or suspected.

What they found was disconcerting: Human-made chemicals were everywhere, even in water hundreds of miles from land.

The study was published Monday in *Nature Geoscience*.

"This presents a pretty sobering view of just how widespread these chemical pollutants have become in the ocean," said Douglas McCauley, an associate pro-

[See Chemicals, A7]

Iran's attacks on fuel facilities stoke fears of escalating war

Gulf nations say they may retaliate. Tehran's strikes further imperil global energy supply.

BY KEVIN RECTOR
AND NABIH BULOS

Iranian attacks on oil and gas facilities around the Persian Gulf on Thursday posed new threats to global energy supplies, as President Trump rebuked Israel for striking a key Iranian gas field, and other nations voiced growing fears that the conflict was escalating.

Saudi Arabia said it might respond with force if Iran continues to attack facilities in the kingdom, and the price of oil once more skyrocketed.

Trump said Israel acted "out of anger" when it attacked Iran's "extremely important and valuable" South Pars field, the world's largest natural gas field. Writing on social media, Trump said there would be "NO MORE ATTACKS" there — which Israeli officials later confirmed — unless Iran persists in striking liquefied natural gas facilities in Qatar.

If Iranian attacks continue, however, the U.S. would "massively blow up the entirety of the South Pars Gas Field at an amount of strength and power that

Iran has never seen or witnessed before," Trump wrote.

The president's remarks came as Iran's intensifying attacks on Persian Gulf energy infrastructure further rattled and angered America's allies in the region and sent shock waves through the global economy. The price of Brent crude oil, the international standard, rose to \$119 a barrel — or up more than 60% since the start of the conflict — before dropping to \$110.

The strikes further threatened a global energy supply already eroded by Iranian attacks on ships in the Strait of Hormuz, through which a fifth of the world's oil is normally transported.

Despite repeated assurances from Trump and other U.S. leaders that the United States is rapidly wiping out Iran's mine-laying, missile and drone capabilities, Iranian attacks have continued on the vital waterway — with one vessel set ablaze Thursday off the coast of the United Arab Emirates and a second damaged off Qatar.

On the other side of the Arabian Peninsula, a Saudi refinery on the Red Sea designed to bypass the strait was hit by an Iranian drone.

The strikes also added to uncertainty around the

[See Mideast, A3]



DPA/Picture Alliance

IRAN STRUCK the Ras Laffan liquefied natural gas facility, shown in early March, QatarEnergy said.

Newsom leads Harris in presidential poll

BY TARYN LUNA

SACRAMENTO — Californians have never been forced to choose between Gavin Newsom and Kamala Harris, two homegrown political darlings, during any election.

But if the state's registered Democrats picked now, Newsom would trounce Harris as their party's next nominee for president and have the edge over other Democratic contenders, according to a poll released Friday by the UC Berkeley Institute of Governmental Studies and co-sponsored by The Times.

Twenty-eight percent of the California Democrats who were surveyed selected the governor as their top choice in the 2028 presidential election. U.S. Rep. Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez

(D-New York) followed with 14% and former U.S. Transportation Secretary Pete Buttigieg received 11%. Harris came in fourth, with only 9% of voters in her own state naming her as their preferred Democratic nominee.

"It's quite a positive result for Newsom," said Mark DiCamillo, director of the Berkeley IGS Poll. "He's separated himself from the rest of the pack, and especially when you compare him to the other major Californian in the considerations, he's three times as much as Kamala. That's quite impressive."

The political careers of the governor and former vice president have orbited each other but never crossed since Newsom was sworn in as San Francisco's mayor and Harris as the city's district attorney on the same

[See Poll, A7]

L.A. Unified defends contract offer

Citing a funding shortfall, district makes its case a day after unions set a strike date. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Friedman listens to Dodgers 'noise'

President of baseball operations discusses expectations and team's culture. **SPORTS, B10**

Weather
Record-tying heat.
L.A. Basin: 93/60. **B6**

Markets **A11**
Opinion Voices **A13**

Uber, Rivian plan a robotaxi future

Partnership could bring 50,000 self-driving vehicles to U.S., Canada and Europe. **BUSINESS, A10**

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